Clout City: Hollywood Music — New Features Spec (Hunts, News, Songs and More)

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This spec covers the features that sit around the core game: treasure hunts, the Story Studio, the News feed, the recurring cast and NPCs, the neighborhood, travel and rest, and the AI song pipeline. It adapts the Clout City New Features Spec; sections 1 to 7 are decided, section 8 is for after P1. All rules from the other documents still apply: no real artists, songs, brands or people; gold only for real money; C$ for virtual cash; real money never shortens a wait, buys an edge or changes a show.

1. Treasure hunts

Version: simplified in v0.3, full in v0.4.

A weekly, opt-in hunt that sends players around Echo Flats following clues, with one track for each of the eight starting scenes (treasures in Clarifications section 14). All tracks share one weekly theme and the same set of places.

1. **Schedule:** Monday at New York midnight to the following Sunday at midnight; stories start Sundays, so they never launch the same day.
2. **Opting in:** the Hunt tab in Tasks/Goals; one tap joins; nothing about the hunt appears for players who haven't joined.
3. **Steps:** 4 to 5, each at a different place. The player travels there (normal price and Energy) and uses the free "Ask around" action for the next clue. Some steps ask a multiple-choice question (wrong answers retry after 10 minutes). From v0.4, one step a week can be a **riff challenge** at Echo Room Studios: echo a 4-note phrase (any accuracy above 60% passes).
4. **Finale:** find the right person at the right place and answer correctly.
5. **Rewards:** a free collectible hunt card, cash about equal to a brand deal, and fame worth about 15 to 20% of an active player's weekly fame; four completed hunts earn a badge.
6. **Rules:** clues are always free; at least one free or cheap step (Lookout Park, the Wall of Almost); steps avoid places affected by the live story; one correct answer per question; invented treasures and musicians only.

	v0.3 (simplified)	v0.4 (full)
Clue delivery	"Ask around" on the location card	NPCs give clues in their lines
Engine	Progress stored per player	A `hunt` arc in the World State layer
World reaction	None	NPC chatter about the treasure for joined players
Places	Wave 2 places	Any released place, including monuments
Riff challenges	No	Yes

Weekly pipeline: Claude drafts the theme and eight tracks by Thursday; the validation script checks places, story conflicts, a cheap step and single correct answers; it goes live Monday unless vetoed in the Story Studio; measure joins, completions and step drop-off.

2. Story Studio

Version: ported from Clout City; hunt review in v0.3, story, song and news review in v0.4.

The one admin dashboard where all story, hunt, news and song content is reviewed, approved, scheduled, previewed and paused. Only admin accounts can open it, checked on the server for every page, request and action.

Area	What it does	Version
Hunt review	The week's theme and eight tracks as players see them, validation results, Approve or Send back	v0.3
Story gates	Gate 1: blueprint and hidden truth. Gate 2: finale and side arcs, beside the editor-pass report	v0.4
Song review (new)	Each song's audio with its stems, every chart in a playable preview, chart validation results, license record, Approve or Send back (section 7)	v0.4 (songs 1 to 4 are approved in the `/lab` page until then)
Scheduling	Story start dates (the pilot included); hunt, news and story-song calendar	v0.4

Area	What it does	Version
Preview	Time travel through any day as players will see it	v0.4
Safety switches	Pause or retire any arc, beat, hunt, news item or song without a deploy	v0.4
News review	City news and cast updates (section 3); auto-published unless vetoed, as in Clout City	With News
Chat reports	The report queue: dismiss, warn, mute or ban	v0.4

3. News

Version: v0.4, on the News app that hosts stories.

The News app is the scene's gossip feed, so there's something new to read every day.

Type	What it is	How often
Story beats	The current story	One a day while a story runs
City news	Developing stories about the invented celebrity world (section 4): feuds, breakups, surprise albums, tour cancellations, comebacks, flops	One or two a day
Scene news	Echo Flats itself: a bandmate quit someone's band, The Rusty Amp's new sound guy, a venue's "best show this week" (players who opt in)	A few a week
Lola's dating column	The advice column as a recurring mini arc	Weekly
Hunt announcement	This week's theme	Mondays

How players see it: the existing live ticker alternates headlines with player activity; the home-screen prompt card shows the newest headline at most once a session; later, headlines pop up on the map at the places they mention.

Fictional celebrities only. Real music news is ruled out: naming real artists risks defamation and publicity-rights claims, summarizing real news raises copyright issues, keeping it current needs daily curation, and avoiding bad news would need judging every day. City news stays light: no real politics, tragedies or crime, and it never changes prices, places or show slots (only stories do).

Production: Claude drafts a week of city news alongside the hunts; it auto-publishes on schedule unless vetoed in the Story Studio. Each item is data (headline, two or three sentences, cast involved, publish day) and moves to the archive after it runs.

4. Recurring cast and NPCs

Version: light NPCs with the v0.4 hunt upgrade; full conversations later.

The cast

- **Story regulars:** Lola Lowdown (narrator), Marty Vance, Esq. (the lawyer with a Page 14 in every contract), Roxy Reyes (The Marquee's booker), the Midnight Saints (Jolene Vega, Moss Delaney and the bassist nobody remembers).
- **The celebrity world (new, for city news):** eight invented stars, one per type, each with a one-line personality, a want and a flaw:

Type	Name	One line
Pop superstar	Vexa Monroe	Wants one normal night; posts every second of it
Rap star	Lil Overdraft	Wants a chart-topper; always "between deals"
Boy band	Five Alarm (a five-piece)	Want to go solo, all five, at once
Rock legend	Dusty Thorne	On his fourth farewell tour
Super-producer	Kayden "Knobs" Okafor	Claims credit for every hit since 2009
Country crossover	Shelby Rae Colt	Wants credibility in two genres; has neither fanbase's trust
Streamer turned singer	DJ Kombucha	Wants to be taken seriously; streams his own therapy
Influencer turned singer	Tiara Vance	"Basically a singer"; Marty's niece

- **The wannabes:** the open-mic regular "almost signed" for six years, a self-declared label CEO with one artist (himself), a busker who claims to have taught everyone.

All names are invented and checked against real artists before launch. Everyone goes into a cast and city bible so they stay consistent across stories, news and hunts.

NPCs at places

Part	How it works
Who	Regulars tied to a place: The Grind's barista, The Rusty Amp's bartender, The Basement's sound guy, Riff & Ruin's clerk, the Lookout Park busker, the tour guide at the CLOUTWOOD sign
Where	At a marked spot in the place's scene with a speech-bubble label
Lines	A rotating line that changes with the live story's phase and with city news ("Did you hear Five Alarm broke up again? Third time this month.")

Part	How it works
Personal updates	Each regular has a small life of their own, updated weekly (the sound guy's band finally got a gig)
Hunts	During a hunt, the right NPC's line becomes that step's clue for joined players (v0.4)
Data	All NPCs and lines are data, written with the week's content

5. A dense starting neighborhood

Version: the base of P1, rolled out in three waves (Milestones and Versions).

Clout City moved to a dense starting neighborhood after testing; Hollywood Music starts that way. Every player lives in Echo Flats, with 19 places close together, so the town feels busy from the first minute and short trips are cheap. The full list is in Clarifications section 3.

Notes

- **Mostly scene cards.** Full interiors are needed only for the homes (one shared apartment template), The Grind (café template plus a stage), the four venues (the shared stage template, re-propped), Riff & Ruin (store) and Echo Room Studios (studio). Everything else needs one illustration.
- **Four stages, one template.** Each venue's stage reuses one template with its own backdrop, lighting, props and crowd size.
- **No school.** The game is 18+, so there's no high school; a community college can come with a later district.
- **No place of worship in P1.** If one is added later, it is generic, gets an invented name and stays out of the stories.
- **The supermarket and fridge** carry over from Clout City: groceries bought at Fresh Flats Market are cooked at home, the budget way to restore Energy.
- **Later districts** (Starline Boulevard, Neon Row, Canyon Heights, the Studio Lot, the Pier District) arrive as new map art and data, a short trip away.

6. Travel, rest at home and food at venues

Version: v0.3. Rules match Clout City; full detail in Clarifications section 8.

Travel: no spending before arriving (a card's actions preview until the player is there; the main button is "Go there"); walk (free, slow, more Energy), metro (cheap), rideshare (fast, pricier) or own ride (the band van or a car; no fares); costs from simple distance bands; a skippable trip view from above; personal timers that never move the shared city clock.

Where	Action	Effect	Limit
Home	Nap	Restores Energy over a short timer	Capped per day
Home	Sit	Some Energy and Mood	Capped per day
Home	Cook a meal	Energy from one fridge meal; no fame	What's in the fridge
Home	Practice	Free, unlimited; no rewards	None
Venues	Grab a drink or snack	Medium Energy, luxury price, no fame	None
Dining places	Eat	Energy by tier; fame once a day	None
Everyone	Midnight top-up	A small amount of Energy each New York midnight	Daily

Groceries: a few cheap bundles at Fresh Flats Market ("Ramen week," "Pre-tour meal prep"), stored in the home fridge up to a set number of meals, consumables that never show on Net Worth and can't be sold. Cooking is the budget option, dining the social and fame option, venue snacks the convenience option.

7. The AI song pipeline

Version: in use from v0.1.5; song review moves into the Story Studio in v0.4.

Decided: the first four songs are made with an AI music tool. Songs 5 and 6 and the pilot's story song are decided before v0.4 (AI or commissioned); they go through the same steps either way. Expect about a day of your time per song, most of it on the charts.

Steps

1. **Brief (Claude writes it).** Title, feel, BPM, key, target length (1:45 to 2:30), a section map (intro, verse, chorus, bridge, outro) marking where Hype phrases and crowd calls will go, mood, and a satirical lyric concept with original lyrics if the song has vocals. Prompts describe genre, era and instruments only; never "in the style of" a real artist.

2. **Generate (you, in the tool).** Make several takes, pick the best, and export the full mix plus stems. The game needs two: the **lead** (the instrument the player plays) and the **backing** (everything else). If the tool can't export stems, separate them with a stem-splitting tool.
3. **Rights record.** Use a plan whose terms grant full commercial use. Save the tool name, plan, a copy of the terms on the day, the generation date and the prompt in the song's record. Two cautions: purely AI-made audio may not be protected by copyright in the US, so others could reuse it (acceptable for P1; your own edits to the arrangement and mix help); and listen for any resemblance to a well-known song before approving.
4. **Master.** Even out loudness across songs (about −14 LUFS), trim silence, and measure the exact BPM and the time of the first beat. Export compressed audio for the web.
5. **Chart.** A charting script built by Claude Code drafts notes for each difficulty from the lead stem's beats and onsets, already within each difficulty's limits. You then play and edit the draft in the chart editor (add, delete, move or lengthen notes on a beat grid; mark Hype phrases and crowd calls).
6. **Validate.** The script checks every chart against Clarifications section 4.12: notes per second, same-lane spacing, hold length, no chords below Club, 2 to 4 Hype phrases, crowd calls only at Club and Theater.
7. **Playtest and approve.** Play every chart on your phone; ask one other person to play the Open Mic and Bar charts cold. Approve in song review (the `/lab` page until v0.4).

Song record (data)

Field	Notes
`id`, `title`, `feel`, `bpm`, `offset_ms`, `duration_s`	Measured in step 4
`stems`	`lead`, `backing` audio files
`charts`	One file per difficulty: `open_mic`, `bar`, `club`, `theater`
`unlock`	`start`, a fame tier, a goal id, or `story` (injected by `song_injection`)
`tags`	e.g. `garage_rock`, `story_song`, `midnight-saints`
`license`	Tool, plan, terms copy, generated date, prompt, or the composer's work-for-hire contract

Field	Notes
`status`	`draft`, `approved`, `paused`, `retired`

Briefs for the first four songs

#	Song	Feel and BPM	Lyric concept
1	Open Mic Night (Be Nice)	Bright indie pop, 92 BPM, simple and steady (the tutorial song)	A nervous first-timer begging a café crowd of nine to clap
2	Rent's Due (Again)	Fuzzy garage rock, 128 BPM, big chorus	A band counting tips in the van the night before rent
3	My Ex Started a Podcast	Glossy synth-pop, 110 BPM	Discovering your breakup is now Episode 4, with sponsors
4	Echo Flats, 3 AM	Lo-fi R&B, 84 BPM, laid-back with long holds	Walking home past every closed venue, still humming the set

8. Later features

Not part of P1; don't build yet. Each needs more players, more art or a proven core first.

Feature	What it is	Why later
New districts and bigger venues	Starline Boulevard, Neon Row, Canyon Heights, the Studio Lot, the Pier District; the Echo Bowl amphitheater (Star) and the Halo Dome stadium (Stadium Status)	Needs map art, venues and harder charts; P1 must prove the ladder first
More instruments	DJ (turntable lanes, scratches, crossfades, after DJ Hero), Vocals (call-and-response, after PaRappa), Drums	Each is its own mechanic and its own charts
Record and release	Record a single at the Studio Lot, release it, earn daily streaming royalties, shoot a music video	A new economy loop; needs balancing against shows

Feature	What it is	Why later
Tours	Book a run of shows across districts over several days	Needs districts
Player bands	Friends as bandmates, a shared band name and fame, co-op shows	Needs live sync and enough players
Battle of the bands	Weekly head-to-head on the same song, judged by score	Needs song leaderboards and anti-cheat beyond P1's checks
Song leaderboards	Top scores per song and difficulty	Needs stronger score verification
Players in the same crowd	See which real players are at a venue, with preset reactions	Needs live presence; stranger chat stays ruled out
Merch tables	Sell band merch at venues	Purchases at places aren't in P1
NPC conversations	Back-and-forth talks with choices	Needs a dialogue system and more weekly writing
News on the map	Headlines pop up at the places they mention	After the News feed proves itself
Seasonal events	Award season, festival weekend, holiday specials with limited songs	After the weekly cadence is stable
Song packs	New songs added in batches, always earned in play, never sold	After the song pipeline has run for a few months